

Monday, 28 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 17° 10°	MANCHESTER Overcast 17° 9°	GLASGOW Overcast 16° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Counter-terror police are leading an investigation after five men were arrested near a major RAF airbase.

The incident unfolded near the airbase, prompting a significant police response. Details are still emerging about what happened. The arrests were made as part of a wider counter-terrorism inquiry.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Andy Burnham warns that a 'broken social care system will in the end break the NHS'.

The Mayor of Greater Manchester is set to outline his proposed care service in detail. He plans to put these reforms on the ballot at the next general election. Social care reform has been a long-standing issue for Mr. Burnham.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

A man has been charged with murder after a woman's death in Darlington.

Andrew Bell, 44, from Darlington, is scheduled to appear before magistrates today. The police investigation is ongoing following the tragic incident. Further details are expected as the case progresses.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Three women have bravely shared their stories after suffering severe infections from cheap eyelid surgery abroad.

They describe terrifying experiences, with one woman so scared to sleep due to infected eyelids. The incidents highlight the risks of travelling abroad for cosmetic procedures. Health experts are urging caution.

HEALTH · UK
- 5

The UK has reportedly jammed satellites to defend itself from hostile threats, amid a growing 'arms race' in space.

Sources indicate that Britain is taking proactive measures to protect its interests in orbit. This development highlights increasing global tensions in space technology. The UK's defence capabilities are adapting to new challenges.

DEFENCE · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready for more backstabbing and intrigue as 'Celebrity Traitors 2' returns this Thursday!**

Twenty-one stars will be battling it out to win a whopping £100,000 for their chosen charities. Expect plenty of twists, turns, and dramatic reveals. Who will be the ultimate Faithful and who will be exposed as a Traitor?

ON AIR – Who are you backing to be the ultimate 'Faithful' or 'Traitor' this series?

TV · THIS WEEK
- 2 The prestigious Booker Prize judges have revealed their shortlist for this year's top literary award.**

Past winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees, promising a fierce competition. The selection process was described as a 'tussle' due to the high quality of entries. The winner will be announced later this year.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted novels, or do you have a favourite author you'd like to see win?

BOOKS · COMING UP
- 3 Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her new movie role on the 'funny Welsh people' she knows!**

In 'Kill Jackie', she plays Jackie Price, a former cocaine dealer targeted by assassins. Zeta-Jones has drawn on her Welsh roots for inspiration. It sounds like a thrilling and darkly humorous new film.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Catherine Zeta-Jones movie, or who's the funniest Welsh person you know?

FILM · COMING UP
- 4 Rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to support Palestinian organisations.**

The tour is set to kick off in Dublin next month, following some recent controversy. Macklemore has been vocal about his support for the cause. It's expected to be a powerful series of concerts.

ON AIR – Are you planning to go to any of Macklemore's tour dates?

MUSIC · NEXT MONTH
- 5 An Indian film from Nagaland is making waves globally and is now on a path towards the Oscars!**

The movie, 'Angh', recently secured a major win at the Toronto Film Festival. It offers a rarely seen glimpse into a unique world. This could be a huge moment for Indian cinema on the international stage.

ON AIR – What's the last international film that really impressed you?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Former Stoke City manager Tony Pulis has voiced the feelings of many fans, asking: "When do Stoke City get our FA Cup?"**

His comments come after Manchester City were found guilty of numerous financial charges. Pulis believes the ramifications should extend to past titles. This ruling has opened a huge can of worms for the Premier League.

ON AIR – Do you think past titles should be re-evaluated after Manchester City's financial breaches?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England have wrapped up their summer ODI series against Sri Lanka with a brilliant century from Tom Banton!**

Banton delivered on his potential, crashing his first international hundred to seal the series win. It was a superb end to the summer for the England side. The team will be looking to build on this momentum.

ON AIR – What's been your highlight of England's cricket summer?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Alexander Zverev led Team Europe to a thrilling Laver Cup victory, clinching the title on the final day!**

Zverev recovered from an earlier defeat to beat Learner Tien in a decisive match. The tournament saw some incredible tennis action. It's a fantastic achievement for Team Europe.

ON AIR – Did you follow the Laver Cup, and what was your favourite moment?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

4 **York Valkyrie made history, becoming the first side to win the Women's Super League three times!**

They stunned favourites Wigan with an incredible defensive effort in the Grand Final. It was a heroic rearguard action that secured their place in the record books. A truly dominant performance from the Valkyrie.

ON AIR – What's been the most impressive sporting achievement you've seen recently?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **The battle to be England's number one goalkeeper is heating up, with James Trafford now challenging Jordan Pickford.**

Pickford has held the position for a long time, but Trafford's recent performances have caught the eye. This competition can only be good for the national team. Who do you think should be Gareth Southgate's first choice?

ON AIR – Who do you think should be England's number one goalkeeper: Pickford or Trafford?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that 'daydreaming with purpose' can significantly boost creativity and problem-solving skills.**
Researchers found that allowing your mind to wander with a specific question or challenge in mind can lead to unexpected and innovative solutions. So, next time you're stuck, try a spot of directed daydreaming!
- 2 The delightful trend of 'vintage picnic blanket collecting' is gaining traction among outdoor enthusiasts.**
From classic tartan to cheerful florals, people are seeking out unique and charming blankets to make their al fresco dining experiences extra special. It's all about adding a touch of nostalgic elegance to your park visits.
- 3 Experts are praising the simple joy of 'reading aloud to your plants' as a surprising stress-reducer.**
While the plants might not understand, the act of speaking calmly and focusing on something green and growing has been shown to have a soothing effect on people. Plus, your houseplants get some nice company!
- 4 A new report highlights the benefits of 'exploring local market towns' for a delightful cultural escape.**
From artisan crafts to regional delicacies, visiting these charming hubs offers a wonderful way to discover unique gifts and enjoy a leisurely day out. It's a fantastic alternative to the hustle and bustle of bigger cities.
- 5 The charming practice of 'leaving friendly notes for your postal worker' is becoming a lovely way to spread cheer.**
Whether it's a simple 'thank you' or a little drawing, these small gestures are making a big difference to those delivering our mail. It's a lovely way to show appreciation for their hard work.
- 6 Researchers are discovering the unexpected health benefits of 'singing in the shower' on a regular basis.**
It turns out belting out your favourite tunes in the bathroom can improve lung capacity, reduce stress, and even boost your mood for the day. So go on, give it some welly!
- 7 The delightful hobby of 'miniature landscape gardening' in terrariums is flourishing amongst indoor plant lovers.**
Creating tiny, self-contained ecosystems with moss, small plants, and decorative elements offers a peaceful and rewarding creative outlet. It's like having a little magical world on your windowsill.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF, HOPING FOR THAT PERFECT COCOA AROMA.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new film, especially if it's a highly anticipated one. What is it?

ANSWER: MAKING SURE ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA ARE PERFECTLY FLUFFED AND ALIGNED.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of aroma' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or feeling, perhaps from your childhood or a happy holiday?

What is that smell for you, and what happy memory does it always bring back?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household gadget' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your life without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?

What is your indispensable little gadget, and why do you love it so much?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The Earth's moon is slowly moving away from us at about 3.8 centimetres per year, meaning that in billions of years, total solar eclipses will no longer be possible.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station regularly enjoy specially designed zero-gravity yoga classes to maintain their flexibility and core strength in orbit.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is wonderfully known as a 'flamboyance'.
- The world's first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by Joseph Nicéphore Niépce.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The iconic red post boxes in the UK were first introduced in 1852.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is often considered to be 'Go.'
- Cats can make over 100 different sounds, whereas dogs can only make about 10.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.

On this day

Day 271 of the year, 94 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Auxerre; Christian feast day: Amalia Abad Casasempere; Christian feast day: Annemund; Christian feast day: Chariton the Confessor. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Alan Wright, English footballer and manager
- 1965 — B.G., the Prince of Rap, American rapper (died 2023)
- 1988 — Hana Mae Lee, American actress, model, and fashion designer
- 1968 — Trish Keenan, English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1967 — Mira Sorvino, American actress
- 1983 — Stefan Moore, English footballer
- 1946 — Jeffrey Jones, American actor
- 1947 — Jon Snow, English journalist and academic

THE DAY TODAY

- 2000 — Al-Aqsa Intifada: Ariel Sharon visits Al-Aqsa Mosque known to Jews as the Temple Mount in Jerusalem.
- 2008 — The Singapore Grand Prix is held as Formula One's inaugural night race, with Fernando Alonso winning the event. Almost a year later it was revealed that Alonso's team-mate Nelson Piquet Jr. had been ordered to crash his car to help bring out the safety car and give Alonso the...
- 2012 — Somali and African Union forces launch a coordinated assault on the Somali port of Kismayo to take back the city from al-Shabaab militants.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Bob Denard and a group of mercenaries take the islands of the Comoros in a coup.
- 1992 — A Pakistan International Airlines flight crashes into a hill in Nepal, killing all 167 passengers and crew.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1983 — John Pat, a 16-year old Aboriginal Australian boy, dies of injuries sustained by four off-duty police officers in Roebourne, a catalyst to the Royal Commission into Aboriginal Deaths in Custody.

- 1941 — Ted Williams achieves a .406 batting average for the season, and becomes the last major league baseball player to bat .400 or better.
- 1995 — Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin and PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat sign the Interim Agreement on the West Bank and the Gaza Strip.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 272 of the year, 93 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles, Duke of Brittany; Christian feast day: Cyriacus the Anchorite; Christian feast day: Hripsime; Christian feast day: Blessed Francesc de Paula Castelló Aleu. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Kelvin Davis, English footballer
- 1942 — Steve Tesich, Serbian-American screenwriter and playwright (died 1996)
- 1980 — Zachary Levi, American actor and singer
- 1970 — Emily Lloyd, English actress
- 1971 — Mackenzie Crook, English actor and screenwriter
- 1980 — Chrissy Metz, American actress
- 1981 — Kelly McCreary, American actress
- 1944 — Isla Blair, British actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1957 — The Kyshtym disaster is the third-worst nuclear accident ever recorded.
- 2009 — The 8.1 Mw Samoa earthquake results in a tsunami that kills over 189 and injures hundreds.
- 2019 — Violence and low turnout mar the 2019 Afghan presidential election.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1954 — The convention establishing CERN (the European Organization for Nuclear Research) is signed.
- 2004 — Burt Rutan's Ansari SpaceShipOne performs a successful spaceflight, the first of two required to win the Ansari X Prize.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 **Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller**

FRI 23 **Frankenstein (del Toro)**

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar